Comparison Table

Comparison of Min Heap K-way merge and pairwise merging.

Parameter	Min Heap K-Way	Pairwise Merge
Number of lists	3	3
Total elements	12	12
Maximum heap size	3	Not applicable
Intermediate result	Not required	Required
Time complexity	O(N log K)	O(NK) general case
Space complexity	O(K)	O(N)
Scalability	Better for many lists	Less suitable for many lists